

Sam Fairclough (he/him)

Stoke-on-Trent, England, United Kingdom

Portfolio: www.samfairclough.com

Sam Fairclough is a software engineer and IT services specialist with strong creative problem solving skills and hands-on experience in both Quality Assurance and Quality Control pipelines, adept in turning ideas into robust solutions. Drawing on experience across interactive software development and QA/QC, he operates confidently within testing pipelines, validation frameworks, and compliance-driven workflows, driving high quality, precision focused outcomes in fast-moving technical environments.

Experience

IT Operations & Quality Control Technician (Temp)

BlankIT – Stoke-on-Trent

January 2026

- Applied hands-on skills across **IT operations**, **QC frameworks**, and **device lifecycle management** to lead quality control operations validating mobile devices, tablets, and laptops etc. against commercial standards, supporting both internal workflows and **client order fulfilment**.
- Took on responsibilities assessing hardware, logging faults, and ensuring devices met **compliance**, safety, and customer specific requirements, including secure data erasure and OS re-flashing.
- Produced and managed **documentation** (including labels, invoices, and compliance paperwork) to accompany orders for key partners, ensuring accuracy, traceability, and **adherence** to numerous required standards.
- Leveraged bespoke systems such as Merlin (inventory) and BlackBelt360, to **catalogue inventory** by quality grade, log hardware faults, and link devices to batch and order records, maximising stock visibility and ensuring a **comprehensive audit** trail for each device, increasing operational efficiency of clients.
- Contributed to internal growth initiatives by producing **graphics and assets** via Canva and Photoshop, supporting streamlined workflows and team productivity.

Playtester/Games Quality Assurance (Project Based/Freelance)

Aardman Interactive – Bristol

2022

- Was responsible for providing support during the **testing** and **quality assurance** process for numerous in-development **games** leveraging Aardman I.P. (Wallace & Gromit, Chicken Run etc.). Attended site-wide sprint meetings to establish standard QA procedure and discuss growth targets and accessibility.

Keywords – Remote

2024/2025/2026

- Have taken part in various remote **games testing** opportunities for notable clients via. keywords/GBTN prior to public release. Specific details unfortunately under NDA.

Games Operative

HB Leisure – Alton Towers (Staffordshire)

March – December 2025

- Delivered engaging guest experiences by operating skill game attractions, managing game mechanics and prize fulfilment, and meeting **sales and service targets** in a fast-paced entertainment environment (over 10,000 customers daily). Developed strong **customer-facing** communication and teamwork skills, tailoring the customer experience to guests.

Retail Assistant (Seasonal)

Smyths Toys (Longton)

September – December 2024

- Utilized product knowledge, particularly in gaming, to drive **sales** and support peak season success, providing excellent **customer service**.

Education

University of Staffordshire

BSc Hons Computer Games Programming (w/ 1st Class Hons)

Key Modules: Artificial Intelligence, Low Level Program Optimisation,, Rapid Games Prototyping, Collaborative Games Development

City of Stoke on Trent Sixth Form College

BTEC Level 3 National Diploma RQF (720) in Digital Games Design and Development (D*D*), Eduqas GCE A Level (A) in Media Studies

Key Modules: Digital Games Production, Games , Concept Art for Computer Games, 3D Modelling, 3D Environments, 3D Digital Animation.

Trentham Academy

GCSE: English Lit. (7), Mathematics (7), Combined Science (8-7), Computer Science (8) etc.

Projects

Global Game Jam 2024 & 2026

Collaborated in a multidisciplinary team to design and develop playable game prototypes within 48 hours, honing rapid prototyping, teamwork, and creative problem-solving skills

UKIE's #RaiseTheGame 2023

Spoke on a seminar panel for The Association for UK Interactive Entertainment's #RaiseTheGame event, discussing how the UK games industry could do more to support graduates from various cultural socioeconomic backgrounds.

VCCP Stoke Student Challenge 2021

I was a member of the winning team for the VCCP advertising agency's Student Challenge, a collaborative media creation and networking project over the course of 3 months which finalised in a weeklong rapid advertisement creation project – for which I was responsible for filming and editing footage.

AccessVFX Industry Mentorship Programme

Worked alongside Daniel Efergan from Aardman Interactive as a mentee, furthering my understanding of one of the UK's fastest growing industries.

SUMC – University of Staffordshire Mountaineering Club

I joined the University of Staffordshire's bouldering group on a bi-weekly basis to develop my rock climbing skills and develop my resilience and communication skills as well as my fitness and mental health.

Qualities & Skills

- Team-Focused • Attentive • Goal-Oriented • Creative • Solution-Focused • Inclusive • Organised
 - Detail-Focused
 - C++/C# • QA/QC • DirectX/OpenGL • SQL • Javascript/Typescript • PhotoShop • Word/Excel • Project Management/Admin • MATLAB
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